



Côte d'Ivoire (Ivory Coast)

One of the larger nations along the coast of west Africa,
Côte d'Ivoire is the world's biggest cocoa producer.
An image of stability was rocked by civil war in 2002–2005.



GEOGRAPHY

Sandy coastal strip backed by a largely rainforested interior, and a savanna plateau in the north.



CLIMATE

High temperatures all year round. South has two wet seasons; north has one, with lower rainfall.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

There are over 60 tribes; the largest is the Baoulé (an Akan group). Southern Christians harbor resentment against non-Ivorian Muslims in the north. Plantations employ millions of migrant workers (including children), though thousands fled back to Burkina during the civil war. Rebels joined a transitional government in 2007.



INSIGHT: *The Basilica of Our Lady of Peace in Yamoussoukro is the largest church in the world*



THE ECONOMY

Main crops are cocoa and coffee. Oil is now major export. Good infrastructure. Lack of professional training. Instability deters investment.



1000m/3281ft
500m/1640ft
200m/656ft
Sea Level

0 100 km
0 100 miles

FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Côte d'Ivoire

DATE OF FORMATION: 1960

CAPITAL: Yamoussoukro

POPULATION: 21.1 million

TOTAL AREA: 124,502 sq. miles
(322,460 sq. km)

DENSITY: 172 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Akan, French*, Krou, other

RELIGIONS: Muslim 38%, Christian 31%, traditional beliefs 25%, other 6%

ETHNIC MIX: Akan 42%, Voltaïque 18%, Mandé du Nord 17%, Krou 11%, other 12%

GOVERNMENT: Transitional regime

CURRENCY: CFA franc = 100 centimes